Rich and fragrant, this characterful soup should be served in small portions. Play around with the quantities of pear and Stilton to find the right balance for you.

pear and stilton soup

SERVES 4 **PREP** 10 MINS **COOK** 20 MINS **FREEZE** UP TO 3 MONTHS
AT THE END OF STEP 1

1 onion, chopped
1 tbsp unsalted butter
4 ripe pears, cored, quartered, and chopped
3¼ cups chicken stock
salt and freshly ground black pepper
4½oz (125g) Stilton, crumbled
juice of ½–1 lemon, to taste
fresh chives, chopped, to serve

1 In a large pan, cook the onion gently in the butter without browning. Add the pears and the stock and season lightly with salt and pepper. Simmer until the pears are very tender. Pass through the fine blade of a mouli-legumes, or process in a blender until smooth. If making this soup in advance, cool it now and continue when you want to serve.

2 Return to the pan and reheat, without boiling. Add the Stilton and stir until melted. Sharpen with lemon juice to taste and adjust the seasoning. Sprinkle the chives over the top and serve.



STILTON
The smell of Stilton is strong, but it should still be pleasant. Try another organic blue cheese in place of Stilton, if you wish. Whatever blue you choose, it should be fresh and moist, but not wet. Cut off any rind before cooking.